Straichemy

Strategies that Strike Gold

Case Study · E-commerce & Retail · D2C Scaling

More than a store — *a brand worth returning to.*

How a D2C lifestyle brand broke through a growth ceiling, fixed its margins, and built customer loyalty that compounds — with **Stralchemy**.

Repeat Purchase Rate	Contribution Margin	Revenue Run Rate
+58%	**+19 pts**	**2.7x**
within 6 months	after channel & SKU restructure	at end of 12-month period

BACKGROUND

A D2C lifestyle brand had done everything right in its first three years — a loyal Instagram following, a flagship product with strong reviews, and consistent month-on-month sales. But somewhere between ₹2Cr and ₹8Cr ARR, momentum stalled. New customer acquisition was expensive, repeat purchases were rare, and a widening product catalogue was quietly eroding margins. The founders were running harder but growing slower.

They engaged **Stralchemy** to diagnose the ceiling — and break through it.

PAIN POINTS

A structured audit revealed four interconnected problems pulling in opposite directions:

Over-reliance on paid acquisition

90% of new customers arrived through Meta and Google Ads. Rising CPMs meant every new customer costs more than the last - with no organic engine to offset it.

No post-purchase experience

The brand excelled at the first sale but had no structured retention loop. Customers bought once and disappeared - with no email journey, loyalty hook, or reason to return.

SKU proliferation killing margins

In pursuit of growth, the brand had expanded to over 60+ SKUs. Inventory was tied up in slow-moving variants, and operations were stretched thin managing complexity with no clear winners.

Brand identity diluted

Trying to appeal to everyone, the brand stood for nothing specific. Messaging was inconsistent across channels - making it easy for competitors to undercut on price alone.

THE **STRALCHEMY** ENGAGEMENT

Stralchemy ran a focused 12-week strategy engagement covering brand, commercial architecture, and customer lifecycle. The goal was not to add more tactics — it was to eliminate the drag and rebuild growth on a defensible foundation.

1. Brand Sharpening

Stralchemy facilitated a positioning workshop that narrowed the target audience from "everyone who cares about lifestyle" to a precise customer archetype. A single brand narrative was built around it — consistent across packaging, website copy, and social content.

2. SKU Rationalization

A contribution margin analysis identified the top 14 SKUs driving 80% of profitable revenue. A structured wind-down plan was built for the rest — freeing up working capital and simplifying operations without disrupting topline.

3. Retention Architecture

A post-purchase email and WhatsApp journey was designed from scratch — onboarding sequence, replenishment nudges, loyalty milestones, and a referral mechanic. The brand finally had a system that worked while the team slept.

4. Channel Diversification Roadmap

Paid dependence was addressed with a 90-day organic content strategy and a marketplace expansion plan targeting quick commerce and curated retail partners — reducing blended CAC structurally, not just tactically.

OUTCOMES

A brand customers remember

Brand search volume grew 3x in six months. Organic traffic surpassed paid for the first time - a structural shift, not a campaign spike.

Retention engine live

The post-purchase journey drove a 58% increase in repeat purchase rate. Average customer LTV climbed from ₹1,200 to ₹2,900 within two purchase cycles.

Leaner, more profitable catalogue

Contribution margin improved by 19 percentage points after the SKU restructure. Operational complexity dropped - the team handled more revenue with fewer moving parts.

Sustainable growth trajectory

Revenue 2.7x in 12 months - with blended CAC down and margins up. The business was no longer dependent on ad spend to grow.

"We thought we had a marketing problem. Stralchemy showed us we had a strategy problem. The work they did in 12 weeks changed the trajectory of the entire business."

Founder, D2C Lifestyle Brand (Identity withheld at client request)

From Concept to Conquest — Begin Here

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